



SERIES PITCH // 2026

PATCH NOTES

Society just dropped an update.

YouTube Series

FORMAT

8–10 min / ep

LENGTH

Weekly

FREQ

18–25

DEMO



Young People Are Ghosting the News

46%

of 18-35s actively
avoid news

Reuters Institute 2023

38%

say news harms
their mental health

Reuters Institute 2023

8 sec

average attention
span before scroll

Microsoft / TikTok data

3 FORMAT CONSTRAINTS:

- ① Hook within 0-30s or the algorithm buries it (YouTube retention curve)
- ② Visual density every ~15s — static talking heads lose 18-25s after 45 seconds
- ③ 8-10 min sweet spot — long enough for depth, short enough for mobile sessions



Treat the World Like a Live-Service Game

THE METAPHOR

Patch Notes

→ Weekly policy/law changes

Nerfs & Buffs

→ Who lost / gained power

Server Downtime

→ System failures (NHS, rail, etc.)

New Season Drop

→ Elections, budget cycles

Exploit Found

→ Loopholes, corruption revealed

WHY IT WORKS

DISTINCTIVE

Zero shows use this framing — not Vox, not Vice, not anyone

SUSTAINABLE

Template-driven — each ep uses same segment skeleton; no reinvention

ALIGNED

77% of 18-25s game — language is native, not patronising

PATCH NOTES — "Society just dropped an update. Here's what changed."



8–10 Minutes. Every Segment Has a Job.



0:00-0:30

LOADING SCREEN

Cold open: one visceral clip or stat. Hook or die.



0:30-2:00

THIS WEEK'S PATCH

3 stories as patch notes. Text overlays mimic in-game UI.



2:00-4:30

DEEP DIVE / NERF ALERT

One story explained properly. Cuts, graphics, no waffle.



4:30-6:30

COMMUNITY REPORT

Twitter/Reddit/TikTok showing how people are reacting IRL.



6:30-8:30

KNOWN ISSUES + FIX?

What nobody's talking about + what could actually fix it.



8:30-9:30

END CREDITS STING

Meme recap, next ep tease, subscribe CTA baked into the joke.



What It Actually Sounds Like

// SCRIPT: EP. 1 COLD OPEN (0:00-0:30)

HOST: Okay. Society shipped a patch this week. There were bugs.

HOST: The government announced rent controls... [beat] ...then quietly added seventeen exceptions including the landlords who wrote the policy.

HOST: Classic balance patch.

ON SCREEN: [ HOUSING.EXE — PATCH v3.7.1 APPLIED] [Known issues remain]

HOST: I'm [NAME]. This is Patch Notes. Let's get into it.

VISUAL DIRECTION

UI OVERLAYS

In-game patch note text boxes appear on screen in real-time

FAST CUTS

News clip → host reaction → text overlay every ~10s

AUDIO

Game SFX (notification ping, error sound) underline key beats

COLOR CODE

Green = good news, Red = nerf, Yellow = bugged / unclear



YouTube Is the Engine. Not the Ceiling.

► YOUTUBE (MAIN)

- Full 8-10 min episode weekly
- Chapters = each patch note is timestamped
- Community posts: 'voting' on next week's deep dive

◆ TIKTOK / REELS

- 60s vertical cuts: one story, one joke, one stat
- Each patch becomes its own clip — 3× content per ep
- 'Patch dropped' audio hook designed for remixing

◉ REDDIT / DISCORD

- r/PatchNotes: community flags 'exploits' we should cover
- Discord server: live 'dev commentary' during upload
- Weekly 'bug report' thread — audience submits next week's stories

◆ NEWSLETTER

- Weekly 'patch notes' email: 3 bullet stories, 1 deep link
- Opt-in, no algorithm dependency — owned audience
- Cross-sell merch: 'KNOWN ISSUES' hoodie, etc.



Shoot the Objections Before They Shoot You

"The gaming framing is a gimmick. It'll get old fast."

REBUFFED

The metaphor is a lens, not a costume. The language updates weekly — each news cycle generates new gaming vocabulary naturally. If rent goes up, that's a nerf. If a new party rises, that's a new character drop. The real world keeps writing the patch notes.

"News needs credibility. Memes undermine trust."

REBUFFED

Credibility comes from accuracy and transparency — not tone. We cite sources on-screen (like Kurzgesagt does). The gaming framing doesn't reduce truth; it replaces false gravitas. Under-25s distrust traditional authority more than they distrust informal voices.

"This will only work for politics. Too niche."

REBUFFED

Patch Notes covers any system that 'updates': climate policy, tech regulation, housing, health, economics, culture. Every institution behaves like a live-service game — bugs, updates, bad actors, unintended consequences. The format is infinitely extensible.



BUILD THE PILOT.

PATCH VERSION 0.1

£ BUDGET

£8-12K for 3-episode pilot

◆ CREW

Host + editor + researcher (3 people)

🕒 TIMELINE

6 weeks pre-production → Episode 1 live

SUCCESS AT 90 DAYS:

- ✓ 10K subscribers by episode 3
- ✓ 45%+ average view duration per episode
- ✓ 3 pieces of organic social content per ep from community

READY TO PATCH? → greenlight the pilot.